PP-C-002045(Army-GL)
February 2, 1978

INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

CHICKEN, FROZEN, COOKED, BONELESS, DICED OR CHUNK

This interim Federal Specification was developed by the U.S. Army Natick Research and Development Command(GL), Natick, MA 01760 based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal Agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers frozen, cooked, boneless, diced or chunked chicken as an item for hospital use.

1.2 Classification. The product shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.1):

Types:

I - Diced chicken
II - Chunked chicken

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

Federal Specifications:

PP-C-248 - Chickens, Chilled and Frozen (Ready-to-Cook)
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

Federal Standards:

FED-STD-123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies)
FED-STD-101 - Preservation, Packaging and Packing Materials: Test Procedures

FSC 8905

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage

(Copies of Military specifications and standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

LAWS AND REGULATIONS

U. S. Department of Agriculture

Regulations Governing the Grading and Inspection of Poultry and Edible Products Thereof and United States Classes, Standards, and Grades with Respect Thereto (7 CFR Part 70)

(Single copies may be obtained from the U. S. Department of Agriculture, Poultry Division, AMS, Washington, DC 20250.)

Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations

(Single copies may be obtained without charge from the U.S. Department of Agriculture, Food Safety and Quality Service, Washington, DC 20250.)

U. S. Department of Health, Education and Welfare

Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulations Promulgated Thereunder

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply:

Association of Official Analytical Chemists

Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Association of Official Analytical Chemists, Post Office Box 540, Benjamin Franklin Station, Washington, DC 20402.)

American Public Health Association

Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Public Health Association, Inc., 1015 18th Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent

Uniform Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent

National Motor Freight Classification

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Traffic Department, 1616 P Street, N. W., Washington, DC 20036.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.1), the supplier shall furnish sample units for first article inspection and approval (see 4.3.4 and 6.3).

3.2 Material. All material shall be clean, sound, wholesome, and in excellent condition, and shall be free from foreign odors.

3.2.1 Chicken. The chicken shall meet the commodity requirements for type I or IV, class 1 or 2, styles 1 through 5 of PP-C-248, U.S. Grade B or better, except that chicken with trimmed breasts (skin removed), which are otherwise Grade B or better may be used. U.S. Procurement Grade I chicken complying with Regulations Governing the Grading of Poultry may be used in lieu of Grade B or better chicken. If type IV frozen chickens are used they shall have been properly packaged and wrapped so as to avoid freezer burn or other damage. Freezer storage time shall be limited to 60 days. The freezer storage time shall be computed from the date the product was put into the freezer. The product shall be in excellent condition and shall show no evidence of thawing or refreezing.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.2.2 Salt. Salt shall be white, refined, free flowing sodium chloride with or without anti-caking agents.

3.3 Processing.

3.3.1 Preparation. The carcass or parts shall be skinned and boned. Alternatively, for type II (chunks) the carcass may be cooked (see 3.3.2). then skinned and boned. Any intermediate stage of preparation necessitating holding of the product within the limits specified in table I shall require prompt cooling to 40°F (4°C) or below. The head, feet, metacarpus-phalanges section of wings, giblets and viscera shall be excluded. Bones, coarse connective tissue, blood clots, skin, bruised or discolored meat exceeding 1/4-inch (6 mm) in any dimension shall be excluded. In addition, ligaments, tendons and cartilage shall be removed. No ground, mechanically deboned or comminuted chicken meat shall be used. The chicken or chicken parts shall not have been frozen more than two times including final freezing for storage and shipment.

3.3.2 Cooking and dicing or chunking. Chicken for type I (diced) shall be cooked in suitable metal molds or casings in steam or water until tender. The cooked chicken for type I shall be mechanically diced with the dicer setting at 5/8 by 5/8 by 5/8 inches (16 by 16 by 16 mm). The cooked chicken for type II (chunked) shall be cut into pieces not less than 1/2 inch (13 mm) and not more than 3/4 inch (19 mm) in diameter. The diced or chunked product shall be frozen in a blast freezer or other type comparable freezer operating at -20°F (-29°C). The temperature of the chicken shall reach 0°F (-18°C) or lower within 24 hours.

3.3.3 Time and temperature limitations. The chicken shall be so handled as to comply with table I.

TABLE I. Time and temperature limitations for handling and storage of component chicken and chicken meat 1/

	Maximum holding period	Maximum temperature
Chilled chicken or chicken meat:		
(a) From preparation (3.3.1) to completion of cooking 2/	72 hours	40°F (4°C)
(b) After cooling, in rolls or logs to start of dicing, chicken to be chunked	48 hours	40°F (4°C) 3/
(c) Total time - all stages combined	5 days	
(d) Chilled meat at completion of any transit between plants		40°F (4°C)

1/ The various increments of time specified for each stage of handling or processing are given to permit maximum flexibility to the supplier and to the

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

processor. At no time shall the quality of the product show any evidence of deterioration in its organoleptic properties.

2/ Following cooking, internal product temperature of 40°F (4°C) or less shall be reached within 24 hours.

3/ Maximum temperature permissible for tempering in preparation for dicing shall be no higher than 30°F (-1°C).

3.4 Finished product. The finished product shall comply with the requirements of table II.

TABLE II. Finished product requirements

Item No.	Physical characteristics
(1)	There shall be no foreign odor such as, but not limited to, burnt, scorched, sour, rancid, musty or moldy.
(2)	There shall be no foreign material such as, but not limited to, dirt, insect(s), insect part(s), wood, paper, feces, ingesta, paint, glass or metal.
(3)	There shall be no bone or hard cartilaginous material larger than 1/4 inch (6 mm) in any dimension.
(4)	There shall be not more than ten percent of the dices or chunks outside of the specified size limits.
(5)	There shall be no evidence of thawing during holding or shipment.

3.4.1 Microbiological requirements. The product shall comply with the following microbiological requirements on a unit basis.

Standard plate count	Not more than 75,000 per gram
E. coli	Negative per gram

3.5 Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act. All deliveries shall conform in every respect to the provisions of the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and Regulation Promulgated Thereunder.

3.6 Plant qualification. The chicken used in the preparation of the product shall be processed in a plant operating under the continuous supervision of the Food Safety and Quality Service, U.S. Department of Agriculture, and shall be inspected, passed and marked in accordance with the Meat and Poultry Inspection Regulations.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preacceptance inspection (plant sanitation inspection).

4.2.1 Civil agencies. When specified (see 6.1), inspection of plants producing the product will be conducted upon request of the contracting officer to the appropriate Government inspection agency. Award of contracts will be limited to establishments known to maintain proper sanitary conditions or which have received prior sanitary approval recommended by the inspection agency.

4.2.2 Military agencies. The product shall be rejected if produced in plants not meeting the requirements of 3.6.

4.3 Acceptance inspection.

4.3.1 Condition inspection of containers. When inspection of product for quality and condition is performed by The US Department of Agriculture, the United States Standards for Condition of Food Containers shall apply. For applicable criteria governing condition inspection of containers for Military agencies see 4.4.4.

4.3.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except as otherwise indicated herein.

4.4 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced specifications, drawings, and standards unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified or qualified in this specification or applicable document.

4.4.1 Examination of chicken. Examination of chicken shall be made in accordance with the examination criteria of the referenced specification in 3.2.1 to determine conformance to the pertinent commodity requirements contained therein and to determine conformance to the condition, temperature and identity requirements of 3.2 and 3.3.1. Records of all applicable control data (temperature and storage time) shall be maintained. Nonconformance to one or more condition or identity requirements reflected by actual examination or by records shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of product or the finished product made therefrom as applicable. Nonconformance to the identity requirements shall be ascertained by examination of the USDA certificate.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.4.2 In-process examination. In-process examination shall be made to determine compliance with the formulation requirements and with the requirements pertinent to processing procedures, controls and equipment of table I. Records shall be maintained reflecting formulations, pressure, time, and temperature. Non-conformance to requirements as determined by actual examination or as reflected by the records shall be cause for rejection of the involved quantity of product.

4.4.3 Examination of end item. Classification of defects found during examination shall be in accordance with table IV through VI. The Inspection levels and AQLs for the tables shall be as shown in table III. AQLs for tables IV & VI shall be expressed in terms of defects per hundred units and as percent defective for table V.

TABLE III. End item examination criteria

Table	Inspection level	Sample unit	Lot size expressed in	AQLs Major A	Major B	Minor
IV	I	One primary container and carton	Primary containers and cartons	0.25	--	6.5
V	S-3	One primary container	Primary containers	--	--	2.5
VI	S-2	Contents of one primary container	Primary containers	1/	1.5	--

1/ The finding of any Major A defect shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.4.4 First article inspection. First article samples of the product which the supplier intends to furnish shall be inspected to insure compliance with 3.4.

4.4.5 Sampling procedures and acceptance criteria for testing of the finished product. The finished product shall be tested for microbiological content in accordance with 4.5.1. Test requirements shall be applicable to the sample unit. The sample unit for testing shall be one filled and sealed primary container for types I and II product. Lot size shall be expressed in terms of primary containers and the sample size shall be the number of sample units called for by inspection level S-2. A nonconformance to any test requirement shall be scored as a defect and shall be cause for rejection of the lot. Microbiological counts shall be reported in accordance with the Standard Methods for the Examination of Dairy Products.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE IV. External examination of container (lined carton and shipping container)

Category		Defect
Major A	Minor	
101		Shipping container not intact
	201	Shipping container not clean
102		Carton not lined or lining not continuous
103		Tears, holes or cuts in carton
	202	Shipping container, not closed
	203	Carton not closed

TABLE V. Examination of filled and closed cartons and shipping containers for net weight 1/ 2/

Category		Defect
Minor	Type	
201	I	Contents of carton less than 10 pounds (4.54 kg)
202	II	Contents of carton less than 10 pounds (4.54 kg)
203	I	Contents of shipping container less than 50 pounds (22.7 kg)
204	II	Contents of shipping container less than 50 pounds (22.7 kg)

1/ Results shall be reported to the nearest ounce (gram).

2/ The lot shall be rejected if sample data indicates the lot average net weight is less than the specified weight.

TABLE VI. Examination of finished product

Category		Defect
Major A	Major B	
101		Foreign odor such as but not limited to burnt, scorched, sour, rancid, musty or moldy.
102		Foreign material such as but not limited to dirt, insect(s), insect(s) parts, wood, paper, feces, ingesta, paint, glass or metal.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

TABLE VI. Examination of finished product (cont'd)

Category		Defect
Major A	Major B	
103		Evidence of undercooked chicken i.e., flesh that is not cooked, appearance of blood around bone.
104		Not in excellent condition. Evidence of thawing or refreezing during holding or shipment.
105		Presence of bone or cartilagenous material larger than 1/4 inch (6 mm) in any dimension.
	151	More than 10% of the discs or chunks outside of specified limits.
106		Presence of head, feet, metacarpus phalanges wings, giblets, ligaments or tendons.
107		Evidence of freezer burn.

4.4.6 Examination of filled and sealed shipping container. Examination of the filled and sealed shipping containers shall be in accordance with the applicable examination criteria contained in the appendix of PPP-B-636. In addition, the following defects shall be included in the table of examination:

Major	National Stock Number, Item Description, Contract Number, Date of Pack, missing, incorrect or illegible.
Minor	Other marking requirements missing, incorrect or illegible.

4.5 Test methods. Examination and test procedures which differ from those specified herein, unless otherwise excepted, may be used by the supplier if they provide a quality assurance equivalent to that specified. If the contracting officer determines that such procedures and controls do not provide, as a minimum such quality assurance, the supplier will use the procedures set forth herein. In case of dispute as to examination or test results, the procedures specified herein will govern.

4.5.1 Microbiological testing. Microbiological testing of the product shall be made as applicable, in accordance with the Official Methods of Analysis of the Association of Official Analytical Chemists (AOAC), Chapter: Microbiological Methods; Section: Prepared Foods; Method: Examination of Frozen, Chilled, Precooked or Prepared Foods - Official First Action.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-packaging.

5.1.1 Level C packaging. Ten pounds (4.54 kg) of type I or type II product, as specified (see 6.1), shall be packaged in a carton so as to protect it from damage and deterioration during shipment from the supply source to the first consuming activity. The interior of the carton shall be coated or lined with a material which will protect the interior of the carton from moisture or fat. The supplier may use his standard practice when it meets these requirements.

5.2 Packing.

5.2.1 Level C packing. Five cartons (50 pounds (22.7 kg)) of the product shall be packed in a snug-fitting shipping container complying with the Uniform Freight Classification or National Motor Freight Classification, as applicable. Fiberboard shipping container shall be closed in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.3 Labeling and marking.

5.3.1 Cartons. Unless otherwise specified, labeling of the carton is not required except that directions for use shall be shown on one face of the carton. If labeling is specified, labeling shall be in accordance with the Federal Food, Drug, and Cosmetic Act and regulations promulgated thereunder. Labeling shall include the date of packaging.

5.3.1.1 Directions for use. Directions for use shall be as follows:

DIRECTIONS FOR USE

Defrost chicken in a refrigerator.
Use defrosted chicken in any recipe calling for cooked, diced or chunked chicken.

5.3.2 Shipping containers. Shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123 or MIL-STD-129, as applicable. The following precautionary marking shall be placed on top of the shipping container.

KEEP FROZEN

(0°F (-18°C) or BELOW)

USE THE SAME DAY AS DEFROSTED

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data.

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) When a first article is required (see 3.1).
(c) Type of product required (see 1.2).

6.2 Destination inspection (for civil agencies only). When the finished product has been inspected and passed at point other than destination, the contract should require that the product be inspected at destination for condition and quantity only.

6.3 First article. When a first article is required it shall be inspected and approved in accordance with the requirements of this specification. The contracting officer should include specific instructions in all procurement instruments regarding arrangements for inspection and approval of the first article.

6.4 Award of contracts. Award of contracts for the product specified in this document will be limited to plants known to maintain the required sanitation conditions of 3.6 and 4.2.

Custodians:

Army - GL

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

HEW-FDA, NIH
GSA-FSS
AGR-AMS
VA-DMS

Project No. 8905-A839

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
US ARMY NATICK RESEARCH and DEVELOPMENT COMMAND
NATICK, MASSACHUSETTS 01760

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300
DRXNM-TD

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY
DOD-314

U.S. MAIL

Commander
US Army Natick Research and Development Command
ATTN: DRXNM-TD
Natick, MA 01760

NATICK OP 1 JUL 77
FOLD

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

INSTRUCTIONS: This form is provided to solicit beneficial comments which may improve this document and enhance its use. DoD contractors, government activities, manufacturers, vendors, or other prospective users of the document are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity. A response will be provided to the submitter, when name and address is provided, within 30 days indicating that the 1426 was received and when any appropriate action on it will be completed.
NOTE: This form shall not be used to submit requests for waivers, deviations or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER *(Number)* AND TITLE

PP-C-002045(Army-GL) Chicken, Frozen, Cooked, Boneless, Diced or Chunk

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS OF SUBMITTER

☐ VENDOR ☐ USER ☐ MANUFACTURER

1. ☐ HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE? ☐ IS ANY PART OF IT TOO RIGID, RESTRICTIVE, LOOSE OR AMBIGUOUS? PLEASE EXPLAIN BELOW.

A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING

B. RECOMMENDED WORDING CHANGE

C. REASON FOR RECOMMENDED CHANGE(S)

2. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address — Optional)*	TELEPHONE NO.
	DATE

DD FORM 1 OCT 76 1426 EDITION OF 1 JAN 72 WILL BE USED UNTIL EXHAUSTED.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-26T12:02Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.